Chapter 7

Kiran Takes On the Chief Minister: Delhi to Goa

THE SHIFT FROM DELHI TO GOA WAS A TRAUMATIC EXPERIENCE FOR Kiran. She had put her heart and soul into her work as DCP (Traffic) and her passion at that time was to succeed one hundred per cent. The Asian games' traffic arrangements were quite indicative of the zeal that was spurring her on at that time. Yet, even while she was in the thick of this challenge, she was sensing 'signals' that she would be 'tolerated' in the Delhi Police only till the duration of the Asian games. And so it was. She was moved out of traffic and out of Delhi to Goa, as soon as the games were over.

'Postings are a part of the job and they have to come sooner or later,' said Kiran later. 'But I ought to have done at least a two-year tenure to consolidate all the initiatives we had taken for improving traffic management so that we could institutionalize them. I fail to understand the urgency in my transfer. In fact, Delhi commuters were high on enthusiasm to accept tough but fair enforcement of traffic rules.' But for the concerned officials at that time all this was not important; what was important for them was to teach Kiran a lesson for being firm and fearless.

On the personal front she had to face a serious situation. The shocking news, which she revealed for the first time, was that her seven-year-old daughter Saina was under close watch by doctors who were treating her for the nephritic syndrome. Saina had had this syndrome since the age of three. And despite such a severe setback, Kiran managed to devote 19 hours a day to her work. 'I could do it because of my mother', she declared proudly. She added: 'When one had a mother like mine I had no reason not to work the way I did. Actually my mother too was contributing her 19 hours a day, for me. It was she who was taking full care of my child. She saw her success in mine. Therefore, I alone did not give put in 19 hours a day. My mother too pitched in. My work actually got 38 hours a day, if that is possible! And this is what made it a grand success.'

Kiran requested the Home Ministry not to dislodge her from Delhi at least. She was willing to take on another assignment within the capital. And, for the first time, she disclosed the reason. Till then, except for the family members and some very close friends, no one knew about Kiran's personal agony. When her colleagues and the public came to know about her anguish, they were all deeply moved. But not the officials in the Home Ministry, who did not even give her a decent hearing.

This is what Kiran had to say after reflecting on the matter:

> I recall how I had to wait endlessly to even get an appointment with officers I thought could help. All I was hoping for was to make them feel the agony the dislocation would cause to my seven-year-old daughter and me. But I was expecting what does not exist in the government, i.e., sensitivity. I also realized here and now that all along in my traffic work I had 'actually' made no friends in power. I had obliged no one then by working for equal enforcement of law. On the